Struggle for Reform: A Theory of Rigging, De-Rigging, Anti-Rigging, and the Structural Conditions of Durable Change

Macharia Barii

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Abstract

The struggle for reform is the effort to *re-form*—to give a new form to the foundation of an order. This paper develops a theory of that struggle. It builds on the Contested Strategic Allocation framework and distinguishes four concepts that are often conflated: *foundation rigging* (the initial advantage a founding confers on the founder's coalition), *de-rigging* (the elimination of a specific advantage), *anti-rigging* (structural provisions that raise the cost of future rigging), and *re-rigging* (the replacement of one advantage with another). The four concepts form a 2×2 matrix that classifies every reform and predicts its durability. The central claim is that most reforms fail short because they de-rig without anti-rigging: they remove the old advantage but do not change the form that produced it, and the result is a re-rigging, often within a generation. The paper shows that the Glorious Revolution of 1688 and the American Constitution succeeded because they combined de-rigging with anti-rigging; that the French and Russian Revolutions failed because they did not; and that the difference is structural, not moral. It then develops a theory of anti-rigging provisions—the structural design that makes future rigging harder—and specifies the conditions under which such provisions are effective rather than nominal. It concludes with implications for revolutionaries, reformers within the rules, and constitution-writers.

Keywords: reform, re-formation, revolution, rigging, de-rigging, anti-rigging, re-rigging, refounding, durable change, constitutional design, political struggle

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1 Introduction

The struggle for reform is the oldest political activity. It is the effort by which those who are disadvantaged by the existing order seek to change it. It takes many forms: petition, protest, litigation, legislation, constitutional amendment, revolution. It is conducted by many actors: reformers, revolutionaries, constitution-writers, corporate governance activists, family mediators. It has many outcomes: success, failure, partial success, unintended consequence.

The word *reform* carries the theory. To reform is to *re-form*—to give a new form to something, to change its shape, to restore or transform its structure. The object of the verb is the *form*, not the content. A reform that leaves the form intact is not a reform in the strict sense; it is a reallocation. A reform that changes the form is a re-founding, even if it happens gradually, legally, and without a shot fired.

This paper develops a theory of the struggle for reform in this strict sense: the effort to *re-form* the foundation of an order. It builds on the Contested Strategic Allocation (CSA) framework, and it distinguishes four concepts that are often conflated:

(1) *Foundation rigging*—the initial advantage that a founding confers on the founder's coalition.

(2) *De-rigging*—the elimination of a specific advantage.

(3) *Anti-rigging*—structural provisions that raise the cost of future rigging.

(4) *Re-rigging*—the replacement of one advantage with another.

The central claim is that *most reforms fail short because they de-rig without anti-rigging.* The reform removes the specific advantage of the old coalition, but it does not change the form that produced that

advantage. The result is a *re-rigging*—the replacement of one advantage with another—often within a generation.

The claim is not a counsel of despair. Some reforms succeed—they de-rig *and* anti-rig—and the paper analyzes the cases where they do. But the general pattern is clear: the struggle for reform is a struggle over form, and a struggle that does not change the form is a struggle that will be repeated.

1.1 Relation to the CSA framework

This paper is an extension of the Contested Strategic Allocation framework. The framework treats games as struggles over shares, under rules, where what each player gets depends on what everyone claims. It identifies the *foundation* as the rules that are not themselves settled by any prior rule, and it identifies the *first allocation* as the allocation of rule-making authority itself.

The framework's central limit is that it brackets the problem of first allocation: it takes the foundation as given and derives allocations from it. The present paper takes up the question the framework brackets: what happens when the foundation is *contested*? When the disadvantaged coalition seeks to change the foundation, what determines whether the change is durable?

The answer, as we will see, is anti-rigging. The framework says that de-rigging without anti-rigging merely resets the board. This paper develops the argument in detail, defines the four concepts, and specifies the design conditions under which a reform is durable.

1.2 Contributions

(1) A definitional framework for four concepts that are often conflated: foundation rigging, de-rigging, anti-rigging, and re-rigging (§2).

(2) A 2×2 matrix that classifies every reform and predicts its durability (§3).

(3) A theory of why most revolutions fall short (§4).

(4) A theory of anti-rigging provisions—the structural design that makes future rigging harder (§5).

(5) An analysis of effectiveness criteria and the nominality problem (§6).

(6) Case studies of the Glorious Revolution, the French Revolution, the American Constitution, and the Russian Revolution (§7).

(7) Implications for revolutionaries, reformers within the rules, and constitution-writers (§8).

2 The Four Concepts

The theory rests on four concepts. This section defines them precisely.

2.1 The etymology of reform

The word *reform* comes from the Latin *reformare*—to form again, to restore to a former shape, to transform. It has carried this double sense—restoration and transformation—since it entered English in the fourteenth century. The object of the verb is the *form*.

This is why the word is exact for the framework. A reform is not a transfer of shares (that is reallocation), a change of players (that is substitution), or a win within the rules (that is competition). A reform is a change in the *form*—the structure, the foundation, the terms on which shares are allocated.

The four concepts of the framework are operations on form:

- *Foundation rigging* is the form as laid: the initial advantage encoded in the foundation.
- *De-rigging* is the removal of the old form's advantage.
- *Anti-rigging* is the change in the terms of laying that makes future forms harder to rig.
- *Re-rigging* is the replacement of one form's advantage with another's.

The struggle for reform is the struggle over form. It is not a struggle over shares; it is a struggle over the terms on which shares are laid.

2.2 Foundation rigging

Definition 2.1 (Foundation rigging)**.** A foundation M^* is *rigged* relative to a benchmark M^0 if there exists a coalition $S \subseteq \mathcal{N}$ and a vector $\alpha(M^*, M^0)$ such that:

(i) $\alpha_i(M^*, M^0) > 0$ for all $i \in S$;

(ii) $\alpha_j(M^*, M^0) < 0$ for some $j \notin S$; and

(iii) the pattern of advantage tracks the identity of the founder (or the founder's coalition) rather than efficiency, desert, or any founder-independent criterion.

The coalition S is the *beneficiary coalition*, and α is the *rigging vector*.

Foundation rigging is the initial advantage that a founding confers on some coalition. It is the original sin of the order, laid at the moment of founding. It is structural: the foundation itself carries the advantage. It is persistent: a self-reinforcing rigging survives within-rules reform. It is asymmetric: the disadvantaged can see it, and the beneficiaries can usually ignore it.

2.3 De-rigging

Definition 2.2 (De-rigging)**.** A refounding M' of a rigged foundation M^* is a *de-rigging* if it eliminates the specific advantage of the beneficiary coalition S: $\alpha_i(M', M^0) \leq 0$ for all $i \in S$, with strict inequality for at least one $i \in S$.

De-rigging is the removal of a specific advantage. It is what the disadvantaged coalition seeks. It is necessary but not sufficient for durable change: a de-rigging refounding may still be a re-rigging if it installs a new advantage in place of the old one.

2.4 Anti-rigging

Definition 2.3 (Anti-rigging)**.** A refounding M' of a rigged foundation M^* includes *anti-rigging* if there exists a set of provisions $\mathcal{A}$ in M' such that the expected cost of future rigging is strictly higher under M' than under M^*: $\mathbb{E}[\text{cost of rigging} \mid M', \mathcal{A}] > \mathbb{E}[\text{cost of rigging} \mid M^*]$. The provisions $\mathcal{A}$ are the *anti-rigging provisions*.

Anti-rigging is not the removal of a specific advantage; it is the change in the *terms of laying* that makes future rigging more costly. It can be present even when de-rigging is absent (partial anti-rigging), and it can be absent even when de-rigging is present (fragile de-rigging).

2.5 Re-rigging

Definition 2.4 (Re-rigging)**.** A refounding M' of a rigged foundation M^* is a *re-rigging* if there exists a coalition $S' \subseteq \mathcal{N}$ such that:

(i) M' is rigged (Definition 2.1) in favor of S';

(ii) $S' \neq S$—the beneficiary coalition has changed; and

(iii) M' preserves the structural features of rigging (explicit favoritism, path dependence, information asymmetry, status-quo bias, or coordinative selection).

Re-rigging is the replacement of one rigging with another. The old elite is replaced; the structure that produced the old rigging is intact. The beneficiary coalition changes; the rigging does not.

3 The 2×2 Matrix

The four concepts form a 2×2 matrix according to whether a reform includes de-rigging (removal of the current advantage) and anti-rigging (raising the cost of future rigging).

	De-rigging	**No de-rigging**
Anti-rigging	Durable de-rigging	Partial anti-rigging
No anti-rigging	Fragile de-rigging	Re-rigging

The matrix is the conceptual core of the theory. Every reform can be placed in one of its four cells, and the cell predicts its durability. We analyze each cell in turn.

3.1 Durable de-rigging

A reform that de-rigs and anti-rigs is a *durable de-rigging*. It eliminates the old advantage and raises the cost of new rigging.

Proposition 3.1 (Durable de-rigging)**.** *A reform that both de-rigs and anti-rigs is a durable de-rigging: it*

eliminates the old advantage and raises the cost of new rigging. It is the only reform that can break the cycle of rigging and re-rigging.

Durable de-rigging is rare. The framework predicts that most reforms will fail to achieve it, because the reforming coalition has the power to rig and no incentive to anti-rig. The cases where it succeeds are the cases we remember.

3.2 Fragile de-rigging

A reform that de-rigs but does not anti-rig is a *fragile de-rigging*. It eliminates the old advantage, but it does not change the structure that produced it. The reforming coalition has the power to lay a new advantage, and by the persistence proposition it will.

Proposition 3.2 (Fragile de-rigging risk)**.** *A reform that de-rigs but does not anti-rig is at risk of re-rigging: if the reforming coalition has the power to lay a new advantage, it will, and the result will be a re-rigging.*

Fragile de-rigging is the most common failure mode. Most revolutions remove the old advantage but do not change the structure. The revolutionary coalition becomes the new beneficiary coalition, with the same procedural rights as the old one. The result is a re-rigging, often within a generation.

3.3 Partial anti-rigging

A reform that anti-rigs but does not de-rig is a *partial anti-rigging*. It raises the cost of *new* rigging but does not eliminate the *old* rigging.

Proposition 3.3 (Partial anti-rigging)**.** *A reform that anti-rigs but does not de-rig raises the cost of new rigging but does not eliminate the old rigging.*

Partial anti-rigging is better than fragile de-rigging, but it leaves the old injustice in place. Some gradualist reforms fit this pattern: they add anti-rigging provisions to the existing foundation without removing the existing advantage.

3.4 Re-rigging

A reform that neither de-rigs nor anti-rigs is a *re-rigging*: it replaces one advantage with another while preserving the structural features of rigging.

Proposition 3.4 (Re-rigging)**.** *A reform that neither de-rigs nor anti-rigs is a re-rigging: the beneficiary coalition changes, but the structure that produced the rigging is intact.*

Re-rigging is the failure mode where the old advantage is replaced by a new one, but the structure of the game is unchanged. The players have changed.

4 Why Most Revolutions Fall Short

The framework gives four reasons why most revolutions fall short, and they are structural, not moral.

4.1 Reason 1: The revolutionary coalition is a coalition of claimants

A revolution is not made by a single actor. It is made by a coalition— sometimes an alliance of classes, sometimes an alliance of factions, sometimes an alliance of convenience. The coalition agrees on the de-rigging: the old foundation must go. It does not agree on what comes next.

The revolutionary coalition that overthrew the French monarchy included the bourgeoisie, the sans-culottes, the peasantry, and the provincial notables. These groups had different interests, different visions, and different claims. The Jacobin dictatorship, the Thermidorian reaction, and the Napoleonic empire were not accidents. They were the resolution of a coalition that could not agree on the terms of the new foundation.

The framework predicts this. The coalition that de-rigs is a coalition of the disadvantaged, but the disadvantaged are not homogeneous. They are disadvantaged by *different* riggings, and they have *different* interests in the new foundation. A coalition that can agree on the de-rigging may not be able to agree on the refounding.

4.2 Reason 2: The revolutionary coalition has the power to rig

The coalition that overthrows the old order holds the power to lay the new foundation. It has the arms, the organization, and the legitimacy of victory. It can write the rules however it wants.

The framework predicts that it will write the rules to its own advantage. This is not a moral failing; it is a structural consequence of the situation. The coalition holds the power to rig, and

the persistence proposition says that a coalition with the power to rig will use it— because the alternative is to leave itself vulnerable to a future de-rigging.

The only way to prevent this is to *remove the power to rig from the revolutionary coalition itself*—through self-limitation, through dispersal, through the anti-rigging provisions described in §5. This is hard to achieve, and it requires the revolutionary coalition to act against its own interest.

4.3 Reason 3: The revolutionary coalition fears the counter-revolution

The reforming coalition is usually surrounded by enemies. The old elite is plotting restoration. Foreign powers may intervene. Internal factions may defect. The coalition feels besieged, and the siege justifies extraordinary measures.

The framework predicts that a besieged coalition will entrench itself. It will acquire emergency powers, suspend normal procedures, and consolidate authority. Each of these is a step toward re-rigging. The siege is real, but the response to the siege is also a re-rigging.

The anti-rigging provisions must be designed to survive the siege. This requires provisions that are *triggered* by the siege itself—for example, sunset clauses that come into force after a specified period, or

review mechanisms that are activated when emergency powers are invoked. These provisions constrain the coalition's ability to use the siege as a justification for re-rigging.

4.4 Reason 4: The revolutionary coalition does not know how to anti-rig

The final reason is the simplest. Anti-rigging is a design problem, and most revolutionaries are not designers. They know how to overthrow; they do not know how to build. They write constitutions that encode their values and their interests, but they do not write provisions that constrain their own power.

The framework's contribution is to specify what anti-rigging looks like. The next section develops a catalogue of provisions.

5 The Theory of Anti-Rigging

5.1 The design problem

Given a rigged foundation M^* and a reforming coalition that wants to de-rig it, the design problem is to choose structural provisions $\mathcal{A}$ for the new foundation M' such that:

(1) the specific advantage of the old beneficiary coalition is eliminated (de-rigging);

(2) future rigging is harder (anti-rigging);

(3) the new foundation does not become a new rigging (the anti-rigging paradox);

(4) the new foundation remains functional.

This is a constrained optimization problem with four constraints: *effectiveness*, *functionality*, *legitimacy*, and *self-limitation*.

5.2 The anti-rigging paradox and its resolution

The reforming coalition is itself a founder. By the legitimacy deficit proposition, the new foundation cannot fully justify itself by the standards it establishes—including the standard that rigging is wrong. If the anti-rigging provisions are strong enough to prevent future rigging, they are strong enough to entrench the reforming coalition. If they are weak enough to avoid entrenching it, they are too weak to prevent future rigging.

Remark 5.1 (The anti-rigging paradox). Every anti-rigging reform faces a paradox: provisions strong enough to prevent re-rigging are strong enough to re-rig by the reforming coalition; provisions weak enough to avoid this are too weak to prevent re-rigging.

The resolution is *self-limitation*: the reforming coalition binds itself with the same provisions it binds its successors.

Definition 5.2 (Self-limiting reform)**.** A reform M' is *self-limiting* if its anti-rigging provisions apply to the reforming coalition as effectively as to its successors. Formally, let $\mathcal{A}_0 \subseteq \mathcal{A}$ be the provisions

applying to the reformers and $\mathcal{A}_1 \subseteq \mathcal{A}$ those applying to their successors. Self-limitation requires $|\mathcal{A}_0| \geq |\mathcal{A}_1|$ and $\text{Enforcement}(\mathcal{A}_0) \geq \text{Enforcement}(\mathcal{A}_1)$.

Self-limitation does not eliminate the legitimacy deficit—the reforming coalition still founded the rules, and every founding carries a deficit. But it reduces the deficit, because a self-limiting reform does not claim an exemption from the standard it imposes.

5.3 Structural provisions

Anti-rigging provisions work through six mechanisms:

(1) **Temporal limits.** Sunset clauses, mandatory review, generational accounting. Provisions that allocate advantage expire unless renewed, and renewal requires the consent of those who would be disadvantaged.

(2) **Concentration limits.** Rotation, sortition, term limits, anti-concentration rules. No coalition holds rule-making authority indefinitely.

(3) **Transparency.** Disclosure, audit, public reasoning. Allocation decisions are visible to those affected.

(4) **Entrenchment asymmetry.** Anti-rigging provisions are harder to remove than ordinary rules but not impossible to remove. The target is a ratio: amendment of an anti-rigging provision requires a supermajority, but amendment of the supermajority requirement requires the same supermajority.

(5) **Dispersal.** Federalism, separation of powers, overlapping trustees. No single coalition captures all rule-making authority.

(6) **Contestability.** Legal standing, referendum, recall. Any affected party can challenge allocation decisions.

No single provision satisfies all four constraints. A *portfolio* of provisions—at least one from each mechanism family—can jointly satisfy them, with each provision compensating for the weaknesses of the others.

6 Effectiveness and the Nominality Problem

6.1 The effectiveness criteria

An anti-rigging provision is *effective* if it satisfies three conditions:

(i) **Bite.** It actually constrains behavior.

(ii) **Cost.** It raises the cost of rigging.

(iii) **Asymmetry.** It imposes a greater cost on the rigger than on the anti-rigger.

A provision that does not bite is decoration. A provision that does not raise the cost is symbolic. A provision that constrains everyone equally is ineffective if the rigger has more resources to bear the cost.

6.2 The nominality problem

Many anti-rigging provisions are nominal. Sunset clauses that are routinely renewed. Transparency provisions that disclose nothing consequential. Entrenchment that is never tested. This is the *nominality problem*: the appearance of anti-rigging without its substance.

The nominality problem is the central practical challenge for anti-rigging theory. A framework that does not address it will produce anti-rigging provisions that look good on paper but do not work in practice.

6.3 Partial solutions

There are partial solutions to the nominality problem:

(1) **Multiple triggers.** A provision triggered by several conditions cannot be evaded by satisfying just one.

(2) **Third-party enforcement.** A provision enforced by parties other than those it constrains cannot be evaded by capture.

(3) **Visible non-compliance.** A provision whose violation is itself visible and costly cannot be evaded silently.

(4) **Sunset on the sunset.** A sunset clause that itself sunsets cannot be renewed indefinitely.

These are partial. A full solution to the nominality problem is an open research question. But the direction is clear: anti-rigging provisions must be designed to bite, to cost, and to impose asymmetric costs on the rigger.

6.4 A formal sketch

Let $\mathcal{A}$ be the set of anti-rigging provisions in a reform M'. The design problem is

$$\max_{\mathcal{A}} \mathbb{E}[\text{durability}] \quad \text{s.t.} \quad \begin{cases} \text{Effectiveness}(\mathcal{A}) \geq \epsilon, \\ \text{Functionality}(\mathcal{A}) \geq \phi, \\ \text{Legitimacy}(\mathcal{A}) \geq \lambda, \\ \text{Self-limitation}(\mathcal{A}) \geq \sigma. \end{cases}$$

Define the *re-rigging hazard* $h(t)$ as the instantaneous probability that a new rigging occurs at time t after a reform. The central claim is

$$h(t \mid \mathcal{A}) \; < \; h(t \mid \varnothing) \quad \text{for all } t.$$

This is not proved, because the hazard function is not specified. It is the formal statement of the framework's central claim, and it points to the empirical question: measure the hazard in orders with and without anti-rigging portfolios.

7 Case Studies

7.1 The Glorious Revolution (1688): durable de-rigging

The Glorious Revolution is the paradigm case of durable de-rigging. James II was overthrown; the Catholic monarchy was replaced by a Protestant one; the specific advantage of the old beneficiary coalition—the Catholic aristocracy, the royal prerogative, the dispensing power—was eliminated.

What distinguishes the Glorious Revolution is its anti-rigging. The Bill of Rights of 1689 established parliamentary supremacy, free elections, freedom of speech in Parliament, and the prohibition of royal interference with the law. The Act of Settlement of 1701 further constrained the monarchy and established the Protestant succession. These provisions included:

- *Temporal limits:* Parliament had to be summoned regularly.
- *Concentration limits:* The royal prerogative was curtailed, and the power to tax was placed under parliamentary control.
- *Transparency:* Parliamentary proceedings were made public.
- *Entrenchment asymmetry:* The Bill of Rights was made difficult to amend.
- *Dispersal:* Power was dispersed between the Crown, the Lords, and the Commons.
- *Contestability:* Elections were made free and regular.

The anti-rigging was self-limiting: it applied to the new monarchs as much as to their successors. The Bill of Rights constrained William and Mary from the moment they accepted the throne. There was no transition period in which the new monarchs were exempt.

The result was a structure in which re-rigging was harder than it would have been otherwise. The Glorious Revolution did not prevent all subsequent re-rigging—the eighteenth-century oligarchy, the nineteenth-century reform movements, and the twentieth-century welfare state were all responses to residual rigging the settlement left in place. But it did prevent the *total* re-rigging that the framework predicts in the absence of anti-rigging. That is what made it glorious.

7.2 The French Revolution (1789–1815): fragile de-rigging

The French Revolution is the paradigm case of fragile de-rigging. The monarchy was overthrown; the aristocracy was abolished; the specific advantage of the old beneficiary coalition—the nobility, the clergy, the royal administration—was eliminated.

But the revolutionary constitutions did not include the anti-rigging provisions that the Glorious Revolution included. There were no temporal limits on the revolutionary government, no concentration limits on the Committee of Public Safety, no transparency provisions for the Jacobin clubs, no entrenchment asymmetry, no dispersal of power across independent bodies, no contestability mechanisms that survived the Terror.

The result was predictable. The revolutionaries acquired emergency powers and never gave them up. The Committee of Public Safety became a dictatorship. The Directory became an oligarchy. Napoleon became an emperor. The Bourbon Restoration restored the monarchy. The July Monarchy installed a new king. The Second Republic became the Second Empire. Each of these transitions was a re-rigging.

The revolutionaries did not bind themselves with the provisions they imposed on others. The Committee of Public Safety claimed the emergency as a justification for extraordinary powers. The Napoleonic regime

claimed the revolutionary legitimacy as a justification for imperial power. Each of these was a failure of self-limitation.

7.3 The American Constitution (1787): durable de-rigging

The American Constitution is a second case of durable de-rigging. The British monarchy was overthrown; the colonial relationship was ended; the specific advantage of the British Crown—the royal prerogative, the colonial administration, the mercantilist system—was eliminated.

The Constitution included a portfolio of anti-rigging provisions:

- *Concentration limits:* Separation of powers, checks and balances, no single branch can dominate.
- *Dispersal:* Federalism, with power divided between the federal government and the states.
- *Contestability:* Elections, judicial review, the amendment process.
- *Entrenchment asymmetry:* The amendment process is difficult but not impossible.

The anti-rigging was self-limiting: it applied to the founders as much as to their successors. The framers of the Constitution were subject to the Constitution they wrote. There was no transition period in which they were exempt.

The American Constitution is the longest-surviving written constitution in the world. It is not without its riggings—the Three-Fifths Compromise, the Electoral College, the malapportionment of the Senate— but it has proven more durable than any comparable reform. The anti-rigging provisions are a major reason.

7.4 The Russian Revolution (1917–1991): re-rigging

The Russian Revolution is the paradigm case of re-rigging. The tsarist aristocracy was overthrown; the specific advantage of the old beneficiary coalition—the nobility, the Orthodox Church, the imperial bureaucracy—was eliminated.

But the Bolsheviks did not de-rig in the framework's sense. They replaced one advantage with another. The party elite, the nomenklatura, and the security services acquired procedural rights that were structurally identical to those of the old elite. The rigging changed hands; the structure was intact.

There was no anti-rigging. The Bolsheviks did not adopt sunset clauses, rotation, transparency, entrenchment asymmetry, dispersal, or contestability. They concentrated authority in the party, the Politburo, and the secret police. They suppressed opposition, abolished independent courts, and controlled the press. Each of these was a step toward re-rigging.

The result was a structure in which the new elite was as entrenched as the old one. The Soviet Union survived for seventy-four years—longer than the tsarist autocracy that preceded it, and longer than most revolutions. But it did not de-rig; it re-rigged. When it finally collapsed, it collapsed into a new rigging—the oligarchic capitalism of the 1990s—which was structurally identical to the old one. The Bolsheviks had replaced one elite with another; the new elite replaced the old one in turn. The game had not changed.

7.5 Comparative lessons

The four cases illustrate the four cells of the matrix:

Reform	De-rigging	Anti-rigging	Outcome
Glorious Revolution	Yes	Yes	Durable de-rigging
American Constitution	Yes	Yes	Durable de-rigging
French Revolution	Yes	No	Fragile de-rigging
Russian Revolution	No	No	Re-rigging

The pattern is clear. The reforms that included both de-rigging and anti-rigging were durable. The reform that included only de-rigging was fragile. The reform that included neither was a re-rigging. The framework predicts this pattern, and the historical record bears it out.

8 Implications for Reformers

8.1 For revolutionaries

The framework's message to revolutionaries is not a counsel of despair. It is a counsel of design.

A revolution can be glorious. It can achieve what it sets out to achieve—the overthrow of an unjust order, the de-rigging of a rigged foundation, the establishment of a new order. But a revolution that does not anti-rig will fall short. It will re-rig, often within a generation, and the new rigging will be as durable as the old one.

The design task is to build anti-rigging into the refounding from the start. This means:

(1) Design the anti-rigging before you take power.

(2) Make the anti-rigging self-limiting.

(3) Build the anti-rigging into the refounding moment.

(4) Design for the siege.

(5) Make the anti-rigging visible.

8.2 For reformers within the rules

The framework has an implication for reformers who work within the rules rather than seeking a refounding. *Anti-rigging reform* is possible: it is within-rules change that raises the cost of future rigging, without removing the current advantage.

Anti-rigging reform is often more durable than revolution, because it does not require a refounding and therefore does not carry the refounding's legitimacy deficit. It is also more modest: it does not claim to end the rigging, only to make future rigging harder.

The reformer who seeks anti-rigging reform should:

(1) Identify the structural features that make the current rigging self-reinforcing.

(2) Propose provisions that raise the cost of those features.

(3) Accept that the old advantage may persist.

(4) Focus on preventing the next one.

8.3 For constitution-writers

The framework has an implication for constitution-writers, who are engaged in the design of foundations. The framework's advice is:

(1) Do not assume that the constitution will be administered by people of good will. Design for the possibility of capture.

(2) Include anti-rigging provisions in the constitution itself, not just in ordinary legislation.

(3) Make the provisions self-limiting: apply them to the framers as much as to their successors.

(4) Build in review mechanisms that allow adaptation without allowing re-rigging.

(5) Make the provisions visible: the citizens must be able to see whether the provisions are being respected.

9 Discussion

9.1 Scope

The theory is a theory of *durable change*. It is useful exactly when the question is whether a reform will last. It is not a theory of which reforms are just, or which revolutions are justified, or what the content of a good constitution should be. Those questions require normative theory that the framework does not supply.

9.2 Relation to normative theory

The theory is descriptive and analytical. It can tell you that a reform that de-rigs without anti-rigging is likely to re-rig. It cannot tell you that anti-rigging is *just*. That requires a theory of justice.

But the theory can inform the normative question. It can tell you that a just reform that does not anti-rig will re-rig, and that an unjust one that does anti-rig may be durable. This is uncomfortable for both redistributionist and meritocratic accounts: it suggests that justice is not sufficient for durability, and that durability is not sufficient for justice. A complete theory would need both.

9.3 Open problems

The theory has several open problems:

(1) **The nominality problem.** A full solution to the nominality problem—the conditions under which anti-rigging provisions are actually enforced—remains open.

(2) **The effectiveness threshold.** The thresholds $(\epsilon, \phi, \lambda, \sigma)$ need calibration from historical data.

(3) **The hazard function.** The re-rigging hazard $h(t)$ needs specification and estimation.

(4) **The self-limitation mechanism.** How can the reforming coalition credibly bind itself? The framework says it must, but not how.

(5) **The trustee problem.** How can anti-rigging provisions protect voiceless players (future generations, non-human nature)?

These are the agenda for a formal anti-rigging theory.

10 Conclusion

The struggle for reform is the struggle to *re-form*—to give a new form to the foundation of an order. It is not the struggle over shares, or over players, or over wins within the rules. It is the struggle over the terms on which shares are allocated, players are counted, and rules are made.

The theory of this paper is that most reforms fail short because they de-rig without anti-rigging. The reform removes the specific advantage of the old coalition, but it does not change the form that produced that advantage. The result is a re-rigging—the replacement of one advantage with another—often within a generation.

The Glorious Revolution of 1688 succeeded because it combined de-rigging with anti-rigging. The American Constitution succeeded for the same reason. The French Revolution failed because it de-rigged without anti-rigging; it changed the players, not the form. The Russian Revolution failed even more completely: it re-rigged without de-rigging.

The lessons are not a counsel of despair. They are a counsel of design. A reform that de-rigs and anti-rigs is durable. A reform that does only one is fragile. The difference is in the form, not in the spirit. And form can be designed.

The word has been carrying the theory all along. To reform is to re-form. The struggle for reform is the struggle over form. It is the oldest political activity, and it is the deepest. The framework's contribution is to make it precise.

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